

Word family: **responsibility / responsibilities / responsible / responsibly / irresponsible / irresponsibility**

Base word: responsibility

Part of speech: mainly **noun**

Related forms:

- * **responsibility** (n.) — 責任；職責；責任感
- * **responsibilities** (plural n.) — 職責；要負責的事情
- * **responsible** (adj.) — 有責任的；負責任的；應負責的
- * **responsibly** (adv.) — 負責任地
- * **irresponsible** (adj.) — 不負責任的
- * **irresponsibly** (adv.) — 不負責任地
- * **irresponsibility** (n.) — 不負責任

Useful expressions / extensions:

- * **take responsibility**
- * **accept responsibility**
- * **bear responsibility**
- * **assume responsibility**
- * **have responsibility for**
- * **be responsible for**
- * **personal responsibility**
- * **social responsibility**
- * **legal responsibility**
- * **parental responsibility**
- * **job responsibilities**
- * **sense of responsibility**
- * **position of responsibility**
- * **responsibility lies with**
- * **shift responsibility**
- * **avoid responsibility**
- * **responsible adult**
- * **responsible behaviour**
- * **responsible for causing**
- * **corporate social responsibility**

Meaning in this passage

> ...I could finally trust myself to handle **responsibilities** properly.

Here, **responsibilities** means:

****the duties, obligations, and important things the speaker was expected to manage — 責任；職責；應做好的事情****

This includes academic work, deadlines, part-time work, and other commitments.

****中文翻譯：****

我終於可以相信自己有能力好好****承擔責任****。

So here:

****responsibilities = 一個人有義務或被期望妥善處理的事情****

1. ****responsibility (責任；職責) — 責任；應負責的事情****

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I could finally trust myself to handle ****responsibilities**** properly.

我終於可以相信自己能夠妥善****處理各種責任****。

Practice 2

> University students have many ****responsibilities****.

大學生有很多需要承擔的****責任****。

Practice 3

> She manages her work and family ****responsibilities**** well.

她能很好地處理工作和家庭上的****責任****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****responsibility = 一個人有義務、職責或被期望妥善完成的事情****

2. ****responsibilities (具體職責) — 職責；工作範圍****

The plural often refers to individual duties.

Practice 1

> My main **responsibilities** include answering emails and preparing reports.

我的主要**職責**包括回覆電郵和準備報告。

Practice 2

> Her **responsibilities** increased after the promotion.

她升職後的**職責**增加了。

MCQ-ready definition:

responsibilities = 某個角色、工作或身份需要完成的一系列具體職責

3. **job responsibilities** — 工作職責

Practice 1

> The interview included questions about my previous **job responsibilities**.

面試包括有關我以前**工作職責**的問題。

Practice 2

> Her **job responsibilities** include managing the team.

她的**工作職責**包括管理團隊。

MCQ-ready definition:

job responsibilities = 某個職位正式要求員工負責的工作和義務

4. **family / parental responsibilities** — 家庭 / 父母責任

Practice 1

> He balances work with his **family responsibilities**.

他在工作 and **家庭責任**之間取得平衡。

Practice 2

> She has significant **parental responsibilities**.

她需要承擔不少**父母責任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

family/parental responsibilities = 因家庭或照顧子女角色而需要履行的義務

5. **responsibility (對某事負責的義務) — 負責 ; 責任**

Practice 1

> I have **responsibility for** the final report.

我**負責**最後的報告。

Practice 2

> She has overall **responsibility for** the project.

她對整個項目負有**整體責任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

have responsibility for X = 有義務管理、處理或確保 X 得到妥善完成

6. **be responsible for something — 負責某事**

A central adjective pattern.

Practice 1

> I am **responsible for** checking the deadlines.

我**負責檢查截止日期**。

Practice 2

> Kevin was **responsible for** the final slides.

Kevin **負責最後的投影片**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****be responsible for X = 有職責或義務處理 X****

7. ****take responsibility — 承擔責任****

A major expression.

Practice 1

> Good leaders ****take responsibility**** for their decisions.

好的領導者會為自己的決定****承擔責任****。

Practice 2

> He finally ****took responsibility for the mistake****.

他終於為那次錯誤****承擔責任****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****take responsibility = 承認某件事是自己的責任，並願意承擔後果或處理它****

8. ****accept responsibility — 接受責任；承認自己有責任****

Practice 1

> She ****accepted responsibility for the error****.

她****承認自己需要為錯誤負責****。

Practice 2

> Nobody wanted to ****accept responsibility****.

沒有人願意****承擔責任****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****accept responsibility = 承認某件事屬於自己的責任，不推卸****

9. ****assume responsibility — 承擔 / 接掌責任****

More formal.

Practice 1

> She **assumed responsibility for the department**.

她**接掌了部門的管理責任**。

Practice 2

> He will **assume responsibility** next month.

他下個月會**接手負責**。

MCQ-ready definition:

assume responsibility = 正式開始承擔某項職責或責任

10. **bear responsibility — 承擔責任；負有責任**

Formal.

Practice 1

> Both sides **bear some responsibility**.

雙方都**負有一定責任**。

Practice 2

> Managers **bear responsibility for workplace safety**.

管理人員對工作場所安全**負有責任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

bear responsibility = 正式表示某人對事件、職責或後果負有責任

11. **responsibility (過錯責任) — 對後果負責；責任歸屬**

A distinct branch from ordinary duties.

Practice 1

> Who bears **responsibility** for the accident?

誰需要為這宗事故**負責**？

Practice 2

> The investigation tried to determine **responsibility** for the failure.

調查試圖確定這次失敗的**責任歸屬**。

MCQ-ready definition:

responsibility = 對某個事件、錯誤或負面結果應承擔的責任

12. **be responsible for causing something** — 是造成某事的原因 / 應負責

A very important ambiguity.

Practice 1

> Heavy rain was **responsible for the delay**.

大雨是造成延誤的**原因**。

Practice 2

> A technical fault was **responsible for the failure**.

技術故障**導致了**這次失敗。

MCQ-ready definition:

be responsible for X = 是造成 X 的原因

Here **responsible** does **not** imply moral blame when the subject is an object or natural cause.

13. **responsibility lies with someone** — 責任在某人身上

Practice 1

> Final **responsibility lies with the manager**.

最終**責任由經理承擔**。

Practice 2

> The **responsibility lies with each individual**.

這項**責任在於每個人自己**。

MCQ-ready definition:

responsibility lies with X = X 是最終需要負責的一方

14. **shift responsibility — 推卸 / 轉移責任**

Practice 1

> He tried to **shift responsibility onto his teammates**.

他試圖把責任**推到隊友身上**。

Practice 2

> Companies should not **shift responsibility** to customers.

公司不應把責任**轉嫁給顧客**。

MCQ-ready definition:

shift responsibility = 把原本應由自己承擔的責任轉到別人身上

15. **avoid / escape responsibility — 逃避責任**

Practice 1

> He was trying to **avoid responsibility**.

他試圖**逃避責任**。

Practice 2

> You cannot **escape responsibility** for your actions.

你不能**逃避自己行為所帶來的責任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****avoid responsibility = 不願承認或承擔自己應負的責任****

16. ****personal responsibility — 個人責任****

Practice 1

> Time management requires ****personal responsibility****.

時間管理需要****個人責任感****。

Practice 2

> We should take ****personal responsibility**** for our choices.

我們應為自己的選擇承擔****個人責任****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****personal responsibility = 個人對自己的決定、行為和義務應承擔的責任****

17. ****sense of responsibility — 責任感****

A very useful meaning extension.

Practice 1

> She has a strong ****sense of responsibility****.

她有很強的****責任感****。

Practice 2

> Part-time work gave him a greater ****sense of responsibility****.

兼職工作令他的****責任感****更強。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****sense of responsibility = 願意認真履行義務、為自己的行為負責的態度****

18. ****responsibility (權責 ; 管理權) — 權責 ; 管理責任****

Responsibility can imply authority as well as burden.

Practice 1

> With promotion comes greater **responsibility**.

升職意味着更大的**權責**。

Practice 2

> She was given more **responsibility** at work.

公司給了她更多**管理責任 / 權責**。

MCQ-ready definition:

responsibility = 因職位而獲得的管理、決定或監督義務

19. **position of responsibility** — 負責任的職位；重要職位

Practice 1

> She holds a **position of responsibility**.

她擔任一個**重要而有責任的職位**。

Practice 2

> He was promoted to a **position of greater responsibility**.

他被提升到一個**權責更大的職位**。

MCQ-ready definition:

position of responsibility = 需要作重要決定、管理他人或承擔重要義務的職位

20. **responsible** (負責任的；可靠成熟的) — 有責任感的

Practice 1

> She is a very **responsible student**.

她是一個很**有責任感的學生**。

Practice 2

> It was a **responsible decision**.

那是一個**負責任的決定**。

MCQ-ready definition:

responsible = 做事謹慎、履行義務並考慮後果的

21. **responsible adult — 有責任感 / 可承擔責任的成年人**

Practice 1

> Children should be accompanied by a **responsible adult**.

兒童應由一名**可靠而能負責的成年人**陪同。

Practice 2

> Leave the keys with a **responsible adult**.

把鎖匙交給一名**有責任感的成年人**。

MCQ-ready definition:

responsible adult = 能作合理判斷並可靠地承擔照顧或監督責任的成年人

22. **responsible behaviour — 負責任的行為**

Practice 1

> Planning ahead is **responsible behaviour**.

提前規劃是一種**負責任的行為**。

Practice 2

> The school encourages **responsible behaviour**.

學校鼓勵學生作出**負責任的行為**。

MCQ-ready definition:

responsible behaviour = 考慮後果並履行應有義務的行為

23. **social responsibility — 社會責任**

Practice 1

> Businesses have a **social responsibility** to consider their impact.

企業有**社會責任**考慮自身造成的影響。

Practice 2

> Environmental protection is often discussed as a matter of **social responsibility**.

環境保護常被視為**社會責任**的一部分。

MCQ-ready definition:

social responsibility = 個人或機構對社會福祉和自身社會影響應承擔的責任

24. **corporate social responsibility — 企業社會責任**

Common abbreviation: **CSR**.

Practice 1

> The company published a **corporate social responsibility** report.

公司發布了一份**企業社會責任**報告。

Practice 2

> Environmental projects form part of its **corporate social responsibility** programme.

環保項目是其**企業社會責任**計劃的一部分。

MCQ-ready definition:

corporate social responsibility = 企業除了盈利外，對社會、員工、環境等承擔的責任

25. **legal responsibility — 法律責任**

Practice 1

> The company may have **legal responsibility** for the damage.

公司可能需要為損害承擔**法律責任**。

Practice 2

> The contract defines each party's **legal responsibilities**.

合約訂明各方的**法律責任**。

MCQ-ready definition:

legal responsibility = 法律規定某人或機構必須承擔的義務或後果

26. **responsibly** — 負責任地

Practice 1

> Use your time **responsibly**.

要**負責任地**運用時間。

Practice 2

> The company promised to act **responsibly**.

公司承諾會**負責任地**行事。

MCQ-ready definition:

responsibly = 以謹慎、可靠、考慮後果並履行義務的方式

27. **irresponsible** — 不負責任的

Practice 1

> Leaving everything until the last minute was **irresponsible**.

把所有事情拖到最後一刻是**不負責任的**。

Practice 2

> It would be **irresponsible** to ignore the warning.

忽視警告會是**不負責任的**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****irresponsible = 沒有妥善履行義務或沒有合理考慮行為後果的****

28. ****irresponsibility — 不負責任****

Practice 1

> His ****irresponsibility**** caused problems for the team.

他的****不負責任****為團隊造成問題。

Practice 2

> The delay was partly caused by poor planning and ****irresponsibility****.

延誤部分是由規劃不善和****缺乏責任感****造成的。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****irresponsibility = 不願或不能負責任地履行義務的態度或行為****

Important distinction 1: ****responsibility = duty vs responsibility = blame****

A major polysemy distinction.

Duty:

> My responsibility is to check the report.

我的****職責****是檢查報告。

Blame/accountability:

> He accepted responsibility for the mistake.

他為錯誤****承擔責任****。

Same noun, but different semantic focus.

Important distinction 2: **responsibility vs task**

task

specific action that needs doing.

responsibility

broader duty or area you are accountable for.

For example:

> Responsibility: manage the presentation.

> 責任：管理整個簡報。

> Tasks: check slides, confirm speakers, upload files.

> 任務：檢查投影片、確認講者、上傳檔案。

One responsibility can contain many tasks.

Important distinction 3: **responsibility vs duty**

They overlap strongly.

duty

often emphasizes obligation—what you are expected or required to do.

responsibility

adds the idea of being accountable for managing something or its outcome.

> duty to follow the rules

> 遵守規則的義務

> responsibility for the project

> 對項目負責

Important distinction 4: **responsibility vs obligation**

obligation

something you must do, often because of law, agreement, morality, or promise.

responsibility

what you are expected to manage or answer for.

Obligation often sounds stronger and more formal.

Important distinction 5: **responsibility vs accountability**

Closely related but not identical.

responsibility

you are expected to do/manage something.

accountability

you must answer for the result.

A team member may have responsibility for a task while the manager has final accountability.

Important distinction 6: **take responsibility vs take charge**

take responsibility

accept duty/accountability.

take charge

begin controlling or leading the situation.

> take responsibility for the mistake

> 承認並承擔錯誤責任

> take charge of the team

> 接管團隊

Important distinction 7: **take responsibility vs admit fault**

admit fault

acknowledge you did something wrong.

take responsibility

broader: acknowledge your role and deal with consequences.

Someone can take responsibility for fixing a problem without necessarily admitting personal fault for causing it.

Important distinction 8: **responsible for = duty vs cause**

Compare:

> She is **responsible for the accounts**.

> 她**負責處理帳目**。

> The storm was **responsible for the damage**.

> 暴風是**造成損害的原因**。

This is one of the most important learner distinctions.

Important distinction 9: **responsible for causing ≠ morally guilty**

> Heavy rain was responsible for the delay.

Rain is obviously not morally guilty.

Here:

responsible for = caused

So context determines whether responsibility is:

* duty,

* accountability/blame,

* simple causation.

Important distinction 10: ****responsible vs reliable****

Very relevant to your passage.

****responsible****

does what should be done and considers consequences.

****reliable****

can consistently be depended on.

Time management made the speaker both:

- * more ****responsible**** in handling duties,
- * more ****reliable**** to other people.

Important distinction 11: ****responsible vs mature****

****mature****

shows adult-like judgment and emotional development.

****responsible****

specifically handles duties and consequences properly.

A responsible action can be evidence of maturity, but they are not identical.

Important distinction 12: ****take responsibility vs bear responsibility****

****take responsibility****

often active/voluntary:

> I accept that this is mine to deal with.

****bear responsibility****

more formal:

> responsibility objectively belongs to this person/group.

Important distinction 13: **assume responsibility**

This can mean:

start taking responsibility

It does not normally mean “guess responsibility.”

Here **assume** = **take on**, not **suppose**.

Important distinction 14: **sense of responsibility**

This means:

責任感

not merely “understanding what responsibility means.”

It describes an internal attitude that motivates someone to do what they should.

Important distinction 15: **responsibilities is often plural for life duties**

In your passage:

> handle responsibilities properly

The plural is natural because the speaker has multiple commitments:

- * university work,
- * deadlines,
- * group work,
- * part-time work,
- * personal organisation.

Important distinction 16: **irresponsible does not simply mean unreliable**

irresponsible

suggests poor judgment or failure to consider duties/consequences.

unreliable

suggests you cannot depend on consistent performance.

Someone could be unreliable because they are forgetful without necessarily acting recklessly.

Family-extension note

Responsibility has several major modern semantic branches:

1. **duties / obligations**

- * responsibilities
- * job responsibilities
- * family responsibilities

2. **being in charge**

- * have responsibility for
- * position of responsibility

3. **accountability**

- * take responsibility
- * accept responsibility
- * bear responsibility

4. **causation**

- * be responsible for the delay

5. **personal character**

- * responsible person
- * sense of responsibility

6. **social/legal domains**

- * social responsibility
- * legal responsibility
- * corporate social responsibility

7. **negative family**

* irresponsible

* irresponsibility

For your passage, the exact branch is:

responsibilities = the various duties and commitments that the speaker needed to manage properly

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
-----	-----	-----
responsibility (duty)	責任；職責	something you must manage
responsibilities	各項職責 / 責任	multiple duties
job responsibilities	工作職責	employment duties
family responsibilities	家庭責任	family obligations
have responsibility for X	負責 X	duty/control
be responsible for X	負責 X	duty
take responsibility	承擔責任	accept accountability
accept responsibility	接受 / 承認責任	acknowledgment
assume responsibility	接掌責任	take on
bear responsibility	負有責任	formal accountability
responsibility for a mistake	過錯責任	blame/accountability
responsible for causing X	導致 X	causation
responsibility lies with X	責任在 X	final responsibility
shift responsibility	推卸 / 轉移責任	transfer blame/duty
personal responsibility	個人責任	self-accountability
sense of responsibility	責任感	attitude
position of responsibility	權責重大的職位	authority/duty
responsible person	有責任感的人	sensible/dependable conduct
responsible behaviour	負責任的行為	considers consequences
social responsibility	社會責任	duty to society
corporate social responsibility	企業社會責任	organizational social duty
legal responsibility	法律責任	legal accountability
responsibly	負責任地	manner
irresponsible	不負責任的	neglects duties/consequences
irresponsibility	不負責任	lack of responsibility

For your original sentence

> That gave me a stronger sense of control, and it also improved my confidence, because I could finally trust myself to handle **responsibilities** properly.

Here:

responsibilities = 學業、截止日期、兼職以及其他自己有義務妥善處理的事情

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 這讓我對生活有更強的掌控感，同時也提升了我的自信，因為我終於可以相信自己有能力好好**承擔責任**。

The cleanest contrast is:

> **task** = 一項具體要做的工作

> **duty** = 應盡的義務

> **responsibility** = **你有義務妥善處理、而且需要對結果負責的事情或範圍**

> **accountability** = 對結果需要交代、承擔後果

In your passage, the speaker has moved from merely **reacting to tasks** to being able to **manage their wider responsibilities reliably**.